Subtracting Three-Digit Numbers

Take away each place. Not enough? Break a ten or a hundred.

468 – 135: take away each place



hundreds	400 − 100 = 300
tens	60 − 30 = 30
ones	8 − 5 = 3
total	300 + 30 + 3 = 333

452 – 127: 2 – 7? Break a ten

break	452 = 400 + 40 + 12
hundreds	400 − 100 = 300
tens	40 − 20 = 20
ones	12 − 7 = 5
total	300 + 20 + 5 = 325

528 – 263: 2 tens – 6 tens? Break a hundred

break	528 = 400 + 120 + 8
hundreds	400 − 200 = 200
tens	120 − 60 = 60
ones	8 − 3 = 5
total	200 + 60 + 5 = 265

Your turn!

643 − 281 = 362

break	643 = 500 + 140 + 3
hundreds	500 − 200 = 300
tens	140 − 80 = 60
ones	3 − 1 = 2
total	300 + 60 + 2 = 362

For teachers

Goal: subtract within 1000 by place value. Check each place first. Not enough ones: break a ten (452 = 400 + 40 + 12). Not enough tens: break a hundred (528 = 400 + 120 + 8).

Subtracting Three-Digit Numbers: Practice

Take away each place. Break a ten or a hundred when you need to.

Part 1 Take away hundreds Only the hundreds change.

1) 700 − 300 = 400

2) 650 − 200 = 450

3) 900 − 600 = 300

4) 840 − 500 = 340

5) 500 − 100 = 400

6) 975 − 300 = 675

7) 380 − 200 = 180

8) 760 − 400 = 360

9) 430 − 100 = 330

Part 2 What is left? The crossed-out parts are taken away. Count what is left.

10) 

357 − 124 = 233

11) 

486 − 152 = 334

12) 

279 − 135 = 144

13) 

395 − 271 = 124

14) 

148 − 36 = 112

15) 

264 − 142 = 122

Subtracting Three-Digit Numbers: Practice (continued)

Part 3 Break a ten Not enough ones. The break row is done for you.

16) **362 − 128 = 234**

break	362 = 300 + 50 + 12
hundreds	300 − 100 = 200
tens	50 − 20 = 30
ones	12 − 8 = 4
total	200 + 30 + 4 = 234

17) **571 − 245 = 326**

break	571 = 500 + 60 + 11
hundreds	500 − 200 = 300
tens	60 − 40 = 20
ones	11 − 5 = 6
total	300 + 20 + 6 = 326

18) **483 − 159 = 324**

break	483 = 400 + 70 + 13
hundreds	400 − 100 = 300
tens	70 − 50 = 20
ones	13 − 9 = 4
total	300 + 20 + 4 = 324

19) **640 − 215 = 425**

break	640 = 600 + 30 + 10
hundreds	600 − 200 = 400
tens	30 − 10 = 20
ones	10 − 5 = 5
total	400 + 20 + 5 = 425

Part 4 Break a hundred Not enough tens. The break row is done for you.

20) **418 − 154 = 264**

break	418 = 300 + 110 + 8
hundreds	300 − 100 = 200
tens	110 − 50 = 60
ones	8 − 4 = 4
total	200 + 60 + 4 = 264

21) **625 − 371 = 254**

break	625 = 500 + 120 + 5
hundreds	500 − 300 = 200
tens	120 − 70 = 50
ones	5 − 1 = 4
total	200 + 50 + 4 = 254

Subtracting Three-Digit Numbers: Practice (continued)

Part 4 Break a hundred (continued)

22) **537 − 281 = 256**

break	537 = 400 + 130 + 7
hundreds	400 − 200 = 200
tens	130 − 80 = 50
ones	7 − 1 = 6
total	200 + 50 + 6 = 256

23) **806 − 452 = 354**

break	806 = 700 + 100 + 6
hundreds	700 − 400 = 300
tens	100 − 50 = 50
ones	6 − 2 = 4
total	300 + 50 + 4 = 354

Part 5 Stack it Cross out and write the new digits on top, then subtract.

24)

	hundreds	tens	ones
		4	13
	4	~~5~~	~~3~~
−	1	2	8
	3	2	5

25)

	hundreds	tens	ones
	6	12	
	~~7~~	~~2~~	4
−	3	6	1
	3	6	3

26)

	hundreds	tens	ones
	3	8	5
−	1	4	2
	2	4	3

27)

	hundreds	tens	ones
	8	11	
	~~9~~	~~1~~	6
−	5	7	3
	3	4	3

Part 6 Nothing to break No help this time.

28)

	5	8	7
−	2	4	3
	3	4	4

29)

	8	9	6
−	1	5	4
	7	4	2

30)

	4	7	9
−	3	2	6
	1	5	3

31)

	6	5	8
−	4	0	5
	2	5	3

32)

	9	3	7
−	6	1	2
	3	2	5

33)

	7	6	4
−	5	3	1
	2	3	3

34)

	3	4	9
−	1	2	7
	2	2	2

35)

	8	7	5
−	2	3	4
	6	4	1

Subtracting Three-Digit Numbers: Practice (continued)

Part 7 Break a ten No help this time.

36)

	6	13	
	4	~~7~~	~~3~~
−	1	3	8
	3	3	5

37)

	4	12	
	6	~~5~~	~~2~~
−	3	1	9
	3	3	3

38)

	7	11	
	3	~~8~~	~~1~~
−	1	5	6
	2	2	5

39)

	8	14	
	7	~~9~~	~~4~~
−	3	6	8
	4	2	6

40)

	5	10	
	5	~~6~~	~~0~~
−	2	3	4
	3	2	6

41)

	3	12	
	8	~~4~~	~~2~~
−	5	1	7
	3	2	5

42)

	2	11	
	9	~~3~~	~~1~~
−	4	0	5
	5	2	6

43)

	6	15	
	2	~~7~~	~~5~~
−	1	4	9
	1	2	6

Part 8 Break a hundred No help this time.

44)

	4	12	
	~~5~~	~~2~~	7
−	1	8	4
	3	4	3

45)

	5	14	
	~~6~~	~~4~~	8
−	2	7	3
	3	7	5

46)

	8	11	
	~~9~~	~~1~~	5
−	3	4	1
	5	7	4

47)

	3	13	
	~~4~~	~~3~~	6
−	1	9	2
	2	4	4

48)

	6	10	
	~~7~~	~~0~~	8
−	3	5	4
	3	5	4

49)

	2	15	
	~~3~~	~~5~~	2
−	1	7	1
	1	8	1

50)

	7	12	
	~~8~~	~~2~~	3
−	4	9	2
	3	3	1

51)

	5	11	
	~~6~~	~~1~~	9
−	2	8	7
	3	3	2

Subtracting Three-Digit Numbers: Practice (continued)

Part 9 Mixed Break only when you need to.

52)

$$\begin{array}{r} 586 \\ -\ 231 \\ \hline 355 \end{array}$$

53)

$$\begin{array}{r} {\scriptstyle 3}\ {\scriptstyle 13} \\ 7\ \cancel{4}\ \cancel{3} \\ -\ 5\ 2\ 8 \\ \hline 215 \end{array}$$

54)

$$\begin{array}{r} {\scriptstyle 3}\ {\scriptstyle 16} \\ \cancel{4}\ \cancel{6}\ 7 \\ -\ 2\ 9\ 3 \\ \hline 174 \end{array}$$

55)

$$\begin{array}{r} 895 \\ -\ 462 \\ \hline 433 \end{array}$$

56)

$$\begin{array}{r} {\scriptstyle 2}\ {\scriptstyle 14} \\ 6\ \cancel{3}\ \cancel{4} \\ -\ 2\ 1\ 9 \\ \hline 415 \end{array}$$

57)

$$\begin{array}{r} {\scriptstyle 4}\ {\scriptstyle 12} \\ \cancel{5}\ \cancel{2}\ 1 \\ -\ 1\ 8\ 0 \\ \hline 341 \end{array}$$

58)

$$\begin{array}{r} 978 \\ -\ 345 \\ \hline 633 \end{array}$$

59)

$$\begin{array}{r} {\scriptstyle 5}\ {\scriptstyle 12} \\ 3\ \cancel{6}\ \cancel{2} \\ -\ 1\ 3\ 7 \\ \hline 225 \end{array}$$

Subtracting Three-Digit Numbers: Practice (continued)

Part 10 Word problems Take away each place.

60) A library has 485 books. Kids borrow 132 of them. How many books are left?

Number sentence **485 − 132 = 353**

Answer **353** books

Draw or show your work

61) A farm had 352 eggs. It sold 127 eggs. How many eggs are left?

Number sentence **352 − 127 = 225**

Answer **225** eggs

Draw or show your work

62) There are 628 seats in a hall, and 274 seats are full. How many seats are empty?

Number sentence **628 − 274 = 354**

Answer **354** seats

Draw or show your work

63) Ben had 540 stickers. He gave away 215 stickers. How many stickers does he have now?

Number sentence **540 − 215 = 325**

Answer **325** stickers

Draw or show your work

64) Challenge: A store had 900 pencils. It sold 350, then 120 more. How many pencils are left?

Number sentence **900 − 350 − 120 = 430**

Answer **430** pencils

Draw or show your work